VOLUME ONE · PALM BEACH · FORT LAUDERDALE · MIAMI

The 365 Yachts
Broker Onboarding Manual

Your first ninety days. What we stand for, what you must complete this week, how you get licensed, how you get paid and how to manage it, and the numbers you will be measured against.

EDITION 2026 · PARTS 0–I · MODULES 01–06 · INTERNAL AND CONFIDENTIAL

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Part 0 — Start Here

Read these three modules before anything else. Fifteen minutes.

How to Use This Manual

You are holding Volume One of a two-volume manual. This volume gets you legal, paid, measured, and productive. Volume Two is everything you will spend the rest of your career referring back to.

The two volumes

Volume	Covers	When you use it
Volume One Onboarding Manual [this document]	Parts 0–I · Modules 01–06 The 365 Standard, your first 90 days, week-one setup, licensing, commission structure, KPIs, and the quick start checklist.	Your first month, then once a quarter to re-check your numbers against the benchmarks.
Volume Two Master Reference	Parts II–X · Modules 07–63 The market, product mastery, the broker's craft, the sales engine, deal execution, brand and retention, competitive positioning, and the reference vault.	Every day, forever. Before calls, during deals, at the dock.

> **ONE NUMBERING SYSTEM**
>
> The two volumes share a single numbering scheme. Modules run **01 through 63** straight across both books, and Parts run **0 through IX**. When any module points you to "Module 34" or "Part VI," that reference resolves the same way whichever volume you are holding. Nothing is duplicated between them.

How to use Volume One

Day one: read it straight through

It is short by design. Forty minutes end to end, and you will understand what is expected of you, how you get paid, and what you have to do this week.

Week one: work the checklist

Module 06 is the operational spine of your first month. Tick it off in order. If you complete it on schedule you will be functional inside thirty days.

Then move to Volume Two

Weeks two through four are product knowledge and process — Parts II and III of the Master Reference. Module 06 tells you exactly what to read and when.

Come back monthly

Module 05 holds the KPIs your monthly performance review is built on. Read your own numbers against it before the review, not during it.

How it is built

- **Numbered throughout** — every part and module carries a number that is unique across both volumes. When a module points you elsewhere, it names the number.
- **Contents** — the table of contents at the front lists every part and module with its page number.
- **Checklists** — every checklist is printed with tick boxes. Work down them with a pen; that is what they are for.
- **Searchable edition** — a web version of this volume is maintained alongside it with identical numbering. Ask your Sales Executive for the link.

What the callouts mean

> **HOUSE RULE**
>
> A 365 Yachts policy. Not a suggestion. If you cannot follow it on a deal, call your Sales Executive before you proceed.
>
> **NEVER**
>
> An action that creates legal, financial, or reputational exposure for you and the firm. There is no version of this that is fine.
>
> **EDGE**
>
> Where we outperform. Use these deliberately — they are the reasons a seller signs with us instead of the brokerage down the dock.
>
> **WATCH**
>
> A common failure point. Most deals that die, die here.
>
> **FIELD NOTE**
>
> Practical intelligence from brokers who have done this hundreds of times. The stuff nobody writes down.

The 365 Standard

We are not selling vessels. We are placing clients into a legacy asset and a lifestyle, and we are doing it with a level of precision the industry has not been forced to match.

The five commitments

Commitment	What it means in practice
Trust	The client hears the bad news from us first. Every time. A survey finding, a soft comp, a lien — we bring it before they find it.
Exclusivity	Curated, not catalogued. We never send a client eleven boats. We send three, and we know why each one is on the list.
Precision	Contracts clean, dates correct, HINs verified, deposits wired. Paperwork errors are self-inflicted losses.
Bespoke	Every client gets a search built around how they actually intend to use the boat, not around what we happen to have listed.
Performance	Activity is measured, coached, and rewarded. Effort is not the same as production, and we are honest with each other about the difference.

The three sentences that define our positioning

> **SAY IT THIS WAY**
>
> **On who we are:** "365 Yachts is a Palm Beach–based international brokerage built for owners who want their transaction handled at the standard of a private banking relationship, not a boat lot."
>
> **On why a seller lists with us:** "You get an exclusive, an honest number backed by real sold comps, a marketing package built to travel internationally, and a broker who is required to update you every week whether there is news or not."
>
> **On why a buyer works with us:** "We will show you three boats, not thirty. We will tell you which one we would not buy, and why. And we will have already called the listing broker before you get in the car."

What we do not do

> **NEVER**

- Quote a listing price we cannot defend with sold comps.
- Send a client to a boat we have not confirmed is still available and in the condition represented.
- Downplay a survey finding to protect a commission.
- Accept a deposit by any method other than wire.
- Speak poorly of a competing brokerage or broker. We win on execution, not commentary.

Your First 90 Days

The brokers who make it past year one all did roughly the same things in the first ninety days. Here they are.

- **Days 1–7 — Get legal, get logged in, get loud** — Paperwork submitted, licensing started, all four platforms accessed. Build your contact list: everyone you know who owns a boat, works on boats, or is wealthy enough to buy one. Target 100 names in the CRM by day seven.
- **Days 8–21 — Learn the product until it is automatic** — Part III of this manual. You should be able to identify a Viking from a Hatteras at 200 yards, explain the difference between a planing and displacement hull to a stranger, and name the four common diesel manufacturers without hesitating. Walk docks. Ask captains questions.
- **Days 15–30 — First inventory calls** — Call on listings. Call FSBOs. Call expired listings. Your objective is not to sell — it is to have 50 real conversations with boat people and build the muscle. Book your first showing, even if it is not your listing.
- **Days 30–60 — First listing signed** — Run a real market analysis. Deliver a listing presentation. Get a Central Exclusive signed and posted correctly. One listing changes everything — it makes you a broker with inventory instead of a broker with hopes.
- **Days 60–90 — First offer written** — Write an offer. Any reasonable offer. Get a P&S executed, a deposit wired, and a survey scheduled. You will make mistakes on your first deal; make them with your Sales Executive on the phone, not alone.
- **Day 90 — Incentive eligibility review** — Bonuses, referral rewards, and performance incentives become available ninety days after your agreement is executed, provided you have closed a minimum of two deals. Book the review.

> **FIELD NOTE**
>
> Inventory is bait. The more listings you carry, the more inbound calls you take, and inbound calls are how you meet buyers you would never have found cold. A broker with six listings does not work harder than a broker with one — they work with more leverage.

Part I — Onboarding & Business Terms

Paperwork, licensing, how you get paid, and what we measure.

01. Week One Setup

Welcome to 365 Yachts. You have joined a team delivering seamless, tech-forward luxury yacht sales to an ultra-high-net-worth clientele. Everything below must be complete before you take your first client call.

Documents to submit

Send all of the following to info@365yachts.org:

- ☐ Photo identification / driver's license
- ☐ Broker or salesperson license and bond copy, if applicable
- ☐ Personal professional bio summary, written by you
- ☐ Professional headshot
- ☐ Executed Employment Contract and NDA
- ☐ Completed W-9

Platform credentials you will receive

Platform	What it is for	First action
365 Yachts Email	All client communication. No personal email for client business, ever.	Install the 365 brand signature block with logo
BoatWizard / YachtWorld	MLS. Listing your inventory, searching for buyers, sold-boat comps.	Log in, run one practice search
YachtCloser	Contracts, e-signature, listing agreements, deals, closing statements.	Log in, review a sample deal file
GoHighLevel CRM	Leads, pipeline, follow-up tasks, campaigns.	Load your first 100 contacts

> **HOUSE RULE**
>
> All client communication runs through your 365 Yachts email address with the brand signature. This is a compliance and brand-consistency requirement, not a preference. Texts and calls are fine and encouraged — but anything that constitutes a record goes through the corporate account.

Also in week one

- Review and familiarize yourself with brand standards and company policies.
- Read this volume end to end, then begin Part II of the Master Reference.
- Book a one-on-one with your Sales Executive to set your commission tier and personal targets.

02. Licensing & Compliance

Florida regulates yacht and ship brokers under Chapter 326, Florida Statutes, administered by the Department of Business and Professional Regulation (DBPR). A license is required to sell or offer to sell any used vessel over 32 feet.

Salesperson vs. broker

	Salesperson	Broker
Surety bond	$10,000	$25,000
Initial application fee	$551	$551
Renewal fee	$500	$500
Change of affiliation	$100	$100
Escrow account	Not required — operates under employing broker	Must maintain an escrow account at a Florida financial institution
License held by	The employing broker, until employment ends	The individual
Term	Temporary 90-day license issued first; permanent two-year license once background checks clear. Renewal notice arrives at least 60 days before expiration.	

Process

- **New to Florida brokerage** — Register with DBPR through the online license portal. Complete application, fingerprints, surety bond, and fee. You will receive a temporary 90-day license while background checks process.
- **Transferring an existing license** — Request a license transfer through DBPR to associate your license with 365 Yachts Inc. Notify your Sales Executive the day you submit.
- **Renewal** — Two-year cycle. Watch for the DBPR notice 60 days out. Do not let a license lapse — you cannot legally take a listing or write an offer with an expired credential.

Official links

- DBPR Yacht & Ship Licensing — applications, forms, requirements

- DBPR Yacht & Ship FAQs — bond amounts, fees, license terms
- Chapter 326, Florida Statutes — the Florida Yacht and Ship Brokers Act

NEVER

Never hold client funds personally, in any form, for any reason. All deposits go to the brokerage escrow account by wire. A salesperson who takes a deposit into a personal account has committed a licensing violation that ends careers.

WATCH

Fee and bond amounts are set by DBPR and change. Verify current figures on the DBPR site before you write a check. The table above reflects the schedule published as of this edition.

03. Commission Structure

Ten percent is the industry-standard gross commission on a brokerage sale. Co-brokered deals split 50/50 between the two brokerages. What varies is your share of the house side — and that is a function of production.

INDUSTRY-STANDARD TIERS

Tier	Broker	House	Who sits here
Junior broker / assistant	30–40%	70–60%	Unlicensed or newly licensed, supported on every deal
New broker	50%	50%	Licensed, building first pipeline
Standard tier	60%	40%	Producing consistently, self-sufficient on deal mechanics
Top performer	70–80%	30–20%	Consistent production or a large portfolio, averaging $10M–$15M+ in annual sales

HOUSE RULE

Your personal split is set individually with your Sales Executive based on experience and performance, formalized in writing with agreed terms, and executed by both parties in your new-hire contract. Nothing in this manual overrides your signed agreement.

Worked examples

Co-brokered deal — 60/40 broker

- Sale price: **$500,000**
- Gross commission at 10%: **$50,000**
- Co-brokerage split 50/50 — 5% to each brokerage side
- 365 Yachts side: **$25,000**
- Your payout at 60%: **$15,000**
- House at 40%: **$10,000**

Solo deal — listing and buyer, 60/40

- Full 10% commission stays in house
- Example gross commission: **$10,000**
- Your payout at 60%: **$6,000**
- House at 40%: **$4,000**

> **VERIFY BEFORE PUBLISHING**
>
> The prior manual illustrated the $500,000 co-broke as **$12,500 gross to the 365 side and $7,500 net at 60%**. That arithmetic implies 2.5% per side, not 5%. The example above uses the standard 10% gross / 50-50 co-broke math. Confirm which figure is intended before this goes to the team, and the table will be corrected to match.
>
> **FIELD NOTE**
>
> The math that matters: a solo deal pays you roughly twice what the same boat pays you co-broked. That is the entire argument for building your own listing inventory rather than living off other brokers' boats. One listing you also sell is worth two you only bring the buyer to.

In-house lead assignments

Brokers are assigned pre-qualified leads generated by 365 Yachts marketing and digital outreach campaigns. These are delivered at no cost to you and frequently represent high-intent buyers or sellers. Commission on in-house assigned deals follows a tiered structure:

- 30% broker / 70% house
- 40% broker / 60% house
- 50% broker / 50% house

Tiers reward performance and ensure consistency in lead follow-up and conversion. Higher percentages are offered to monthly top performers, or awarded by the Sales Executive to winners of specified sales competition campaigns.

Bonuses, incentives & partnership

- **Performance incentives** — bonuses, referral rewards, and other performance-based incentives become available within ninety (90) days of execution of your agreement by both parties, provided you have closed a minimum of two (2) deals.
- **Partnership and strategic opportunities** — 365 Yachts actively welcomes discussions on partnership collaboration and strategic business opportunities, and wants you rewarded

for any connection you bring. Send a full detailed overview and contact information to shelly@365yachts.org for review.

> **HOUSE RULE**
>
> All commission payments are processed after funds are received and contracts are complete — same-day wire transfer.

04. Commission Income Management

You are paid in irregular lumps, taxed as an independent contractor, and carried by nothing in between. More new brokers leave this business for financial reasons than for lack of ability. This module is here because we would rather you last.

> **WHY THIS IS IN THE MANUAL**
>
> Most brokerages will not have this conversation with you. We do, because a broker worrying about rent does not prospect well, does not hold firm in a negotiation, and takes the wrong listing at the wrong price. Your financial stability is a performance issue, not a private one.

The three facts about how you get paid

Fact	What it means for you
1. It is lumpy, not monthly	You may close nothing for two months and then close twice in a week. Your expenses do not work that way. The gap between those two rhythms is what has to be managed.
2. Nothing is withheld	Commission arrives gross. No income tax withheld, no self-employment tax withheld. The money in your account is not all yours, and the bill arrives whether you set it aside or not.
3. It lags the work by months	The prospecting you do in January pays in April. Which means the month you feel richest is the month you are most tempted to stop doing the thing that made you rich.

The first thing to do — before your first commission

Open a second bank account. Not an investment account, not something clever. A plain second checking or savings account at the same bank, so transfers are instant.

- **Commission arrives in your main account** — The full gross amount, same-day wire.
- **Same day, move the tax portion to the second account** — Before you look at the balance, before you plan anything. Same day, every time, no exceptions.
- **Treat the second account as not yours** — Because it is not. It belongs to the IRS and you are holding it.

- **What remains is your actual income** — Budget from that number and only that number.

> **WATCH**
>
> The single most common financial failure in commission sales is spending a gross commission as though it were net. A $15,000 payout is not $15,000 of income. Brokers who learn this in April of their second year learn it expensively.

What to set aside

As a 1099 contractor you owe federal income tax and self-employment tax, and you generally pay both through quarterly estimated payments rather than at year end.

> **GET THIS FROM A PROFESSIONAL**
>
> The correct set-aside percentage depends on your total income, filing status, deductions, state of residence, and other factors specific to you. **Nobody at 365 Yachts — including your Sales Executive — can tell you what your number is.** Engage a CPA in your first month, before your first commission, not at tax time. A CPA who understands independent contractors will pay for themselves several times over in your first year.

What we can tell you is the structure to ask your CPA about:

- What percentage of each gross commission should I set aside?
- Do I need to make quarterly estimated payments, and on what dates?
- What can I legitimately deduct — mileage, dockage for showings, phone, licensing and bond, professional dues, home office, marketing?
- Should I be operating as a sole proprietor or an entity?
- What records do I need to keep, and in what form?

Runway — the number that decides whether you last

Runway is how many months you could cover your fixed costs with no commission at all. It is the most important number in your first two years, and most brokers have never calculated it.

- **6–9** — Months of runway recommended before you start
- **90** — Days minimum from first prospecting call to first close
- **3** — Months minimum to rebuild after a dry spell

Ninety days is the realistic floor between starting and closing, and that assumes everything goes right. Deals die at survey. Closings slip. A boat you were counting on goes to a cash buyer. Runway is what lets you keep working the process instead of panicking and taking a listing at a price that will never sell.

> **FIELD NOTE**
>
> Brokers with no runway make identifiable mistakes: they overprice listings to win them, they chase unqualified buyers because they cannot afford to disqualify anyone, and they push for a close the client is not ready for. Clients feel all three. Financial pressure is visible from the other side of the table, and it costs deals. Protecting your runway is protecting your judgement.

Managing the lumps

Pay yourself a salary

After tax set-aside, move a fixed monthly amount to your spending account and leave the rest. Smooth your own income. Live on the salary, not on the closings.

Set the salary on a bad year

Base it on what you would earn in a slow year, not your best month. Anything above it is surplus, not lifestyle.

Rebuild runway first

After a big close, the first call on the surplus is restoring your months of runway. The reward comes after the buffer, not instead of it.

Keep fixed costs low early

Every fixed monthly commitment shortens your runway and raises the number you must close to survive. Year one is not the year to add them.

The trap of the good month

The most dangerous month in a broker's year is the one right after a large close. Two things happen at once: fixed costs go up, and prospecting stops. Ninety days later the pipeline is empty and the lifestyle is not.

> **HOUSE RULE**
>
> Prospect hardest in the week you close. It is the least natural time to do it and the most important. Your pipeline is the only thing standing between a good month and a bad quarter — and it is built ninety days before you need it.
>
> **NOT FINANCIAL ADVICE**
>
> This module is practical guidance on how commission income behaves, not financial, tax, or investment advice. Percentages, deductions, entity structure, and payment schedules are specific to you and belong with a qualified CPA or financial adviser.

05. KPIs & Performance Benchmarks

Consistency and accountability are what separate brokers who last from brokers who visit. These are the metrics we track.

- **25+** — New qualified leads per month
- **4×** — Follow-ups per prospect, weekly
- **1–3** — New listings signed per month
- **3+** — Showings scheduled per week
- **2–5** — Offers presented per month
- **1–2** — Closed sales per month

CRM hygiene — daily, non-negotiable

- Every conversation logged as a note the same day it happens.
- Every contact carries a next action with a date. No contact sits without one.
- Pipeline stage updated the moment reality changes, not at month end.

> **WATCH**
>
> The single most common cause of a broker washing out is a CRM full of names and empty of next actions. If a lead has no scheduled follow-up, that lead does not exist. Twenty-five new leads a month with no follow-up produces nothing; ten with disciplined follow-up produces a career.

Performance reviews

Performance reviews are conducted monthly with sales leadership to help you stay on track, overcome hurdles, and optimize your conversion funnel. You may schedule a private one-on-one session with your Sales Team Manager at any time for an individual strategy session or additional training. Use it. The brokers who ask for coaching outperform the brokers who wait to be coached.

How to read your own numbers

If this is low	The real problem is usually	Fix
New leads	Not enough outbound activity or no referral ask	Inventory calls, dock walking, ask every client for two names
Showings	Sending too many boats, or unqualified buyers	Send three, not thirty. Qualify financing on call one. Vol. Two, Modules 26 and 34.
Offers	Not asking for the offer	Vol. Two, Module 36 — trial closes. Ask on every showing.
Closes	Offers dying at survey or on price	Vol. Two, Modules 35 and 39 — objections and negotiation
Listings	No market analysis, or pricing to please the seller	Vol. Two, Modules 22 and 37 — run real comps, present them

06. Quick Start Checklist

Tick these off in order. If you complete this list on schedule you will be functional inside a month.

Week 1 — Administrative & access

- ☐ All onboarding documents submitted to info@365yachts.org
- ☐ Employment contract and NDA executed
- ☐ W-9 submitted

- ☐ Licensing application filed or transfer requested with DBPR
- ☐ 365 email active, brand signature installed
- ☐ Logged into BoatWizard, YachtCloser, and GoHighLevel
- ☐ Commission tier confirmed in writing with Sales Executive
- ☐ Read Parts 0–I of this manual

Week 2 — Product & market knowledge

- ☐ Read Part III of the Master Reference in full — types, hulls, engines, systems, builders
- ☐ Can name the six hull types and what each is good for
- ☐ Can name the top five sportfish, center console, and motor yacht builders
- ☐ Walked at least two marinas and spoken to three captains or dockmasters
- ☐ 100 contacts loaded into GoHighLevel with next actions
- ☐ Ran three practice searches in BoatWizard MLS
- ☐ Ran one practice SoldBoats comp search

Week 3 — Live activity

- ☐ Read Parts V and VI of the Master Reference — scripts, objections, deal execution
- ☐ Made 50 outbound calls to boat owners, FSBOs, or expired listings
- ☐ Shadowed a showing with a senior broker
- ☐ Built and sent one three-boat buyer package by email and by text
- ☐ Completed one full market analysis for a real prospect
- ☐ Delivered one listing presentation

Week 4 — First transaction mechanics

- ☐ Walked through a YachtCloser listing agreement start to finish with a manager
- ☐ Walked through a YachtCloser deal and P&S with a manager
- ☐ Posted a practice listing in BoatWizard (or a real one)
- ☐ Saved the surveyor and haul-out yard directory to your phone
- ☐ First listing signed or first offer written

Ongoing — every week, forever

- ☐ 25+ new qualified leads added this month
- ☐ Every active prospect touched 4× this week
- ☐ 3+ showings scheduled this week
- ☐ Every listing client updated, news or no news
- ☐ CRM notes current, every contact carries a dated next action
- ☐ Monthly performance review booked with sales leadership

What comes next

That is Volume One. Everything from here — the market, the boats, the craft, the scripts, the deal mechanics, the reference vault — lives in **Volume Two, the Master Reference**, Parts II through

IX, Modules 07 through 63. Your week-two through week-four reading is in there. Ask your Sales Executive for your copy and the link to the searchable edition.

Who to call

Shelly Melcher

Co-Founder · CEO · Licensed Employing Broker · Sales Director

Direct: 561-445-9241
Email: shelly@365yachts.org
Web: 365yachts.org · 365YachtMatch.com

> **HOUSE RULE**
>
> For any question about a deal, a client, a contract, or your commission — call. Do not guess on anything that touches a client's money or the firm's compliance. Nobody has ever been criticized here for asking.

Volume Two — What Comes Next

Where the rest of the manual lives.

The Master Reference — Modules 07 to 63

Volume One made you legal, paid, and measured. Volume Two makes you good.

Part	Modules	What it gives you	Read it
II · The Market	06–09	The industry, current conditions, the South Florida ecosystem, and the economics behind it.	Week two
III · Product Mastery	10–16	Yacht types, hulls, engines, systems, builders, design, and maintenance intervals.	Week two
IV · The Broker's Craft	17–27	Responsibilities, ethics, compliance, valuation, market analysis, surveys, international deals, financing, insurance, Florida tax, flag registration, maritime law.	Week three
V · The Sales Engine	31–40	Pipeline, boat shows, discovery, the full script library, objection handling, buying signals, listing presentations, showings, negotiation, follow-up.	Week three, then before every call

Part	Modules	What it gives you	Read it
VI · Deal Execution	41–50	Contract anatomy, deal timeline, escrow and deposits, wire fraud, co-broke etiquette, YachtCloser and BoatWizard click-by-click, survey day, closing.	Week four, then every deal
VII · Brand & Retention	51–55	The listing launch, listing quality standards, digital marketing and SEO, personal brand, client retention.	Month two
VIII · Expanding Your Book	56–57	Charter brokerage and new construction — two revenue lines beyond pre-owned.	When you are producing
IX · Competitive Position	58–59	How 365 wins, and word-for-word talk tracks for competitive questions.	Before your first listing presentation
X · Reference Vault	60–63	Surveyor directory, haul-out yards, glossary, tools, links, contacts, standing figures.	At the dock, permanently

GET YOUR COPY

Ask your Sales Executive for the Master Reference and the link to the searchable edition. Save the searchable version to your phone home screen before your first showing — the surveyor directory and haul-out yard list in Part IX are the pages you will reach for in the field.

FIELD NOTE

The brokers who last read Part III until the product knowledge is automatic, and skim Part V for thirty seconds before every call. Those two habits, done consistently, outperform natural talent in this business every time.

Notices

365 Yachts Broker Onboarding Manual — Volume One, Edition 2026. Internal and confidential. Distribution limited to 365 Yachts Inc. brokers and staff.

Standards, commission structures, and contract terms stated in this manual are subject to your executed individual agreement, which governs. Licensing fees, bond amounts, and regulatory requirements are set by the Florida DBPR and change — verify current figures before relying on them. This manual is training material, not legal, tax, or financial advice.

Questions, corrections, and additions: shelly@365yachts.org